PalmSource™ 99

Backward Compatibility

Cheri Leonard
Development Support Engineer

3Com
More connected.

Overview

PalmSource 99

- Why should I make sure my solution is backward compatible?
- How do I create a “backward compatible” solution?
- How do I make sure my solution is backward compatible?
- What about forward compatibility?
- What about cross device compatibility?
- How does Palm Computing test for backward compatibility?

Why Should I Make My Solution Backward Compatible?

PalmSource 99

- The money of course!
  - Lots of new and old devices that can't or won't be upgraded



How Do I Create a "Backward Compatible" Solution?

PalmSource 99

Palm OS® SDK can help!

- Look to the source code samples as an example

```
// Hide the font controls that are used in
   version 1.0 and 2.0.
FrmHideObject (frm, FrmGetObjectIndex
   (frm, NoteSmallFontButton));
FrmHideObject (frm, FrmGetObjectIndex
   (frm, NoteLargeFontButton));
```

From Address.c Line 2407

How Do I Create a "Backward Compatible" Solution?

PalmSource 99

Palm OS® SDK can help!

- Read the Compatibility Guide! —Appendix B of the Palm OS® SDK Reference
- Review the documentation on the APIs and see if there is a "backward compatibility" version of the API
- Use the APIs and Use them Correctly!

What about Forward Compatibility?

- Use the APIs and use them correctly!
- Don’t hack the hardware—it may change
  Dragonball EZ is a good example of this
- Don’t use Palm databases if possible, they may not be there in the next version

What about Cross Device Compatibility?

- Make sure the feature is present before running the API
  - Example: If you are using a barcode scanner use the API to verify that a barcode scanner is there
  - Example 2: If you are depending on being apart of a wireless network, make sure you are connected before you transmit the data







How Does Palm Computing Test for Backward Compatibility?

PalmSource 99

- Extensive third-party solution library
  - Run large number of solutions through test cases similar to the Platinum logo program
  - Want to increase the chances that we'll test your solution? Email John_Arena@palm.com for more information
- Internal Beta programs where more third-party solutions testing is done
- External Beta testing too!

How Do I Make Sure My Solution Is Backward Compatible?

PalmSource 99

- Test Test Test
  - Don’t have to buy all the devices—USE POSE
  - Test on both debug and release versions of the ROM images
  - Go to the licensee websites and test their ROM images as well
  - In the developer seeding area of the solution provider pavilion, the release ROM images and some of the debug ROM images are available for you to download; use these with POSE to see if your solution will work on all those devices

Backward Compatibility

- Questions?








PalmSource™ 99
3Com
More connected.